

# Benjamin S. Manning

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| CONTACT                  | bmanning (at) mit.edu ◇ <a href="https://benjaminmanning.com">benjaminmanning.com</a>            |                                        |                |
| EDUCATION                | <b>Massachusetts Institute of Technology</b>                                                     |                                        |                |
|                          | Ph.D. Management Science, Information Technology                                                 |                                        | 2022 - Present |
|                          | S.M., Management Research                                                                        |                                        | 2024           |
|                          | <b>Harvard University</b>                                                                        |                                        |                |
|                          | M.P.P. Economic & Social Policy                                                                  |                                        | 2021           |
|                          | <b>Washington University in St. Louis</b>                                                        |                                        |                |
|                          | B.A. Mathematics (College Honors)                                                                |                                        | 2017           |
| REFERENCES               | John Horton (Chair)                                                                              | Christopher Norio Avery                |                |
|                          | MIT Sloan School of Management                                                                   | Harvard Kennedy School                 |                |
|                          | jjhorton (at) mit.edu                                                                            | christopher_avery (at) hks.harvard.edu |                |
|                          | Colin F. Camerer                                                                                 | Siddharth Suri                         |                |
|                          | California Institute of Technology                                                               | Microsoft Research                     |                |
|                          | camerer (at) caltech.edu                                                                         | siddharth.suri (at) microsoft.com      |                |
| GRANTS<br>(\$483,325)    | Schmidt Sciences AI at Work Award (\$193,325)                                                    |                                        | 2025           |
|                          | Emergent Ventures Fast Grant (\$50,000)                                                          |                                        | 2025           |
|                          | MIT GenAI Impact Consortium & OpenAI (\$180,000; w/ John Horton)                                 |                                        | 2025           |
|                          | Schmidt Sciences Grant Proposal Award (\$10,000)                                                 |                                        | 2025           |
|                          | Emergent Ventures Fast Grant (\$50,000)                                                          |                                        | 2024           |
| AWARDS &<br>SCHOLARSHIPS | WISE Best Paper Award                                                                            |                                        | 2025           |
|                          | Harvard Distinction in Student Teaching Award                                                    |                                        | 2025           |
|                          | Becker Friedman Institute Price Theory Summer Camp                                               |                                        | 2025           |
|                          | Kosciuszko Foundation Tuition Scholarship (\$6,500)                                              |                                        | 2019 & 2022    |
| WORKING<br>PAPERS        | <b>General Social Agents</b>                                                                     |                                        |                |
|                          | (Benjamin S. Manning <sup>1</sup> & John Horton)                                                 |                                        |                |
|                          | Revise & Resubmit at <i>Econometrica</i>                                                         |                                        |                |
|                          | • WISE 2025 Best Paper Award                                                                     |                                        |                |
|                          | • Extended abstract at <i>ACM Conference on Economics &amp; Computation (EC '26)</i>             |                                        |                |
|                          | • Media: <a href="#">Marginal Revolution</a>                                                     |                                        |                |
|                          | <b>Automated Social Science: Language Models as Scientist and Subjects</b>                       |                                        |                |
|                          | (Benjamin S. Manning <sup>1</sup> , Kehang Zhu <sup>1</sup> , & John Horton)                     |                                        |                |
|                          | Reject & Resubmit at <i>The Quarterly Journal of Economics</i>                                   |                                        |                |
|                          | • Extended abstract at <i>ACM Conference on Economics &amp; Computation (EC '26)</i>             |                                        |                |
|                          | • Media: <a href="#">Marginal Revolution</a>                                                     |                                        |                |
|                          | <b>Large Language Models as Simulated Economic Agents: What Can We Learn from Homo Silicus?</b>  |                                        |                |
|                          | (John Horton <sup>1</sup> , Apostolos Filippas <sup>1</sup> , Benjamin S. Manning <sup>1</sup> ) |                                        |                |
|                          | Revise & Resubmit at <i>The Review of Economics and Statistics</i>                               |                                        |                |
|                          | • Extended abstract at <i>ACM Conference on Economics &amp; Computation (EC '24)</i>             |                                        |                |
|                          | <b>Self-supervised Preference Learning for Multimodal Foundation Models</b>                      |                                        |                |
|                          | (Akshata Tiwari <sup>1</sup> , Jillian Ross, Benjamin S. Manning, & Andrew Lo)                   |                                        |                |
|                          | <i>Under Review at NeurIPS</i>                                                                   |                                        |                |

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<sup>1</sup>Indicates first author or co-first authors

PEER-  
REVIEWED  
PUBLICATIONS

**Prompt Adaptation as a Dynamic Complement in Generative AI Systems**

(Eaman Jahani<sup>1</sup>, **Benjamin S. Manning**, Joe Zhang, Hong-Yi TuYe, Mohammed Alsobay, Christos Nicolaides, Siddharth Suri, & David Holtz<sup>1</sup>)  
*Information Systems Research*, 2026

- Media: [Marginal Revolution](#), [MIT Ideas Made to Matter](#)

**National Megastudy Shows that Email Nudges to Elementary School Teachers Boost Student Math Achievement, Particularly When Personalized**

(Angela Duckworth<sup>1</sup>, Katherine Milkman, ... **Benjamin S. Manning**, ..., & 26 others)  
*Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 2025

**Effect Size Magnification: No Variable is as Important as the One You're Thinking About—While You're Thinking About It**

(Linnea Gandhi<sup>1</sup>, **Benjamin S. Manning**, & Angela Duckworth)  
*Current Directions in Psychological Science*, 2024

- Top 10 most downloaded Association for Psychological Science (APS) journal articles in 2024
- Media: [Under the Cortex](#)

REFEREED  
CONFERENCE  
PROCEEDINGS

**Strategic Tradeoffs Between Humans and AI in Multi-Agent Bargaining**

(Crystal Qian<sup>1</sup>, Kehang Zhu<sup>1</sup>, John Horton, **Benjamin S. Manning**, Vivian Tsai, James Wexler, & Nithum Thain )  
*ACM Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (IUI)*, 2026

BOOK  
CHAPTERS

**The Coasean Singularity? Demand, Supply, and Market Design with AI Agents**

(Peyman Shahidi<sup>1</sup>, Gili Rusak<sup>1</sup>, **Benjamin S. Manning**<sup>1</sup>, Andrey Fradkin<sup>1</sup>, & John Horton<sup>1</sup>)  
Forthcoming in *The Economics of Transformative AI*

- Media: [Marginal Revolution](#), [MIT Initiative on the Digital Economy](#)

IN PROGRESS

**Taste-as-Program: Scalable Preference Elicitation with Artificial Intelligence**

(Gili Rusak<sup>1</sup>, **Benjamin S. Manning**<sup>1</sup>, & John Horton)

**Recapitulating all of Experimental Economics with AI Agents**

(**Benjamin S. Manning**<sup>1</sup> & John Horton<sup>1</sup>)

**Natural Language Algorithms: What Happens When AI Agents Pick Your News?**

(**Benjamin S. Manning**<sup>1</sup> & Alex Moehring<sup>1</sup>)

**What Causes Financial Bubbles? Theory and Evidence from Simulations and the Lab**

(Cady Ngo<sup>1</sup>, **Benjamin S. Manning**<sup>1</sup>, Christopher Avery<sup>1</sup>, & Colin Camerer<sup>1</sup>)

**A Data-Driven Approach to Designing Better Nudges: A Case Study in Math Education**

(Marcos Gallo<sup>1</sup>, Sean S. Hu<sup>1</sup>, **Benjamin S. Manning**, Angela Duckworth, & Colin Camerer)

**Will The Real Psychohistory Please Stand Up?**

(**Benjamin S. Manning**<sup>1</sup> & John Horton)

TEACHING

*15.575*: Economics of Information and Information Technology, **TA for John Horton & Alessandro Acquisti**—MIT, Spring 2026

*QSTBA 830*: Business Experimentation and Causal Methods, **Guest Lecturer for Andrey Fradkin**—Boston University, Spring 2025

*BUSN 38802*: Managerial Decision Making; **TA for Richard Thaler**, University of Chicago—Booth London Campus, Fall 2024 (Rating: 4.7/5.0)

*API-101Z*: Markets and Failures; **TA for Christopher Avery**—Harvard University, Fall 2024 (Rating: 4.6/5.0)

*API-101Z: Markets and Failures*; **TA for Christopher Avery**—Harvard University, Fall 2023  
(Rating: 4.3/5.0)

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|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| AFFILIATIONS  | MIT Initiative on the Digital Economy, Heterodox Academy                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |             |
| REFEREEING    | <b>Economics:</b> <i>Quarterly Journal of Economics, Experimental Economics, Southern Economic Journal</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |             |
|               | <b>General Interest:</b> <i>Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |             |
|               | <b>Management:</b> <i>Management Science, Manufacturing and Service Operations Management, International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS)</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |             |
|               | <b>Computer Science:</b> <i>Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), ACM-Collective Intelligence</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |             |
|               | <b>Sociology:</b> <i>Sociological Science</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |             |
| INVITED TALKS | <b>Program Committees:</b> <i>ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (2026), The Business Implications of Generative AI (BIG.AI) (2026), Workshop on Agent Behavior at the Conference on Language Modeling (COLM) (2026), Conference on Digital Experimentation (CODE) (2023)</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |             |
|               | <b>Grants:</b> <i>J-PAL Project AI Evidence</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |             |
|               | <b>2026 (Includes scheduled talks):</b> MIT Center for Information Systems Research (CISR) Hot Topic Webinar; NBER AI and Economic Measurement Conference; Columbia Management, Analytics, and Data Conference; Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference; University of Connecticut Seminar (Operations & Information Management); The Business Implications of Generative AI (BIG.AI); Digital Economy Workshop Athens; Chapman University Brownbag Seminar; AEA Annual Meeting.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |             |
|               | <b>2025:</b> Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE); Conference on AI, Machine Learning, and Business Analytics; Dartmouth Economics Seminar; North American Meeting of the Economic Science Association (ESA); Instacart Economics Team Seminar; NYU Workshop on AI and the Future of Collaborative Innovation; KOF ETH Zurich and IZA Workshop: Matching Workers and Jobs Online; Machine Learning in Economics Summer Conference (MLESC25); Academy of Management (AOM) Annual Meeting; International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2); Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference; AI, Mechanism Design and Human Behavior: Experiments and Theory NBER/CEME Decentralization Conference; Khipu Latin American Meeting in AI; Artificially Intelligent Social Science Workshop (Oxford); AEA Annual Meeting. |             |
|               | <b>2024:</b> Conference on AI, Machine Learning, and Business Analytics; NABE Tech Economics Conference; Informs Annual Meeting; Machine Learning in Science Conference; Econometric Society Interdisciplinary Frontiers Conference on Economics and AI+ML; ZEW Conference on the Economics of ICT; International Conference of the French Association of Experimental Economics; Instacart Economics Team Seminar; Statistical Conference in E-Commerce Research (SCECR); Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference; International Meeting on Experimental and Behavioral Social Sciences; MIT IDE Annual Conference; Microsoft Research AI, Cognition, and the Economy Workshop; Measuring Development: AI, the Next Generation at the World Bank.                                                                                            |             |
| EMPLOYMENT    | <b>2023:</b> Interactive Causal Learning Conference; MIT CODE; MIT CSAIL's FutureTech Seminar; Talking to Machines AI Workshop at Oxford University.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |             |
|               | <b>University of Pennsylvania</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 2021 - 2022 |
|               | Research Assistant for Angela Duckworth                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |             |
|               | <b>University of Chicago</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2020 - 2022 |
|               | Research Assistant for Jon Rogowski                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |             |
|               | <b>Dartmouth College</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 2018 - 2019 |
|               | Research Assistant for Sydney Finkelstein                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |             |

**Phetpittayakom School**  
High School Math Teacher in Thailand

2017 - 2018

**Optiver US LLC**  
Execution Trading Intern

2016